

MINISTRY OF COOPERATION

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA

(SPECIAL OPERATIONAL GUIDELINES: FORMATION AND CONVERGENCE OF PACS AS FARMER PRODUCER ORGANIZATIONS (FPOs))

PURPOSE OF FPO

The primary purpose of this initiative is to actively promote producer collectives, such as Farmer Producer Organizations (FPOs) and Primary Agricultural Credit Societies (PACS), to build a robust cooperative ecosystem. By emphasizing the integration of primary producers, the scheme aims to significantly improve aggregation capabilities, enable seamless market

access, foster rural value addition, and build institutional capacity

ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA

Eligibility is extended to all eligible farmer-producer groups, cooperative structures, and registered_entities that strictly meet the current FPO programme conditions.

This includes Primary Agricultural Credit Societies (PACS) seeking diversification, existing farmer collectives, and newly formed producer groups that comply with the regulatory and financial benchmarks established by the Ministry of Cooperation and its allied ministry partners.

Plains Areas: An FPO must have a minimum of **300 farmer-members** to qualify for scheme benefits.

- **North-Eastern & Hilly Regions:** An FPO must have a minimum of **100 farmer-members**.
- **Base Groups:** Members are typically mobilized initially into small groups of 15–20 farmers (e.g., Farmer Interest Groups or Self Help Groups) before aggregating into the FPO.

[\[1\]](#)

BENEFITS:

- **Lower Input Costs:** Bulk purchasing of seeds, fertilizers, and pesticides reduces production costs for individual farmers.
- **Higher Selling Prices:** Direct bulk marketing bypasses middlemen, securing better prices for produce.

- **Bargaining Power:** Aggregating small farmers into a large legal entity creates strong leverage when negotiating with corporate buyers.
- **Cheaper Credit:** Registered FPOs qualify for institutional bank loans, collateral-free credit guarantees, and direct government equity grants.
- **Direct Market Linkages:** Connects farmers directly to exporters, retail chains, food processors, and digital trading platforms like e-NAM.
- **Modern Agriculture Technology:** Simplifies the adoption of drone tech, precision farming, and high-yield crop varieties through institutional guidance.
- **Extension Services:** Streamlines the delivery of government-backed weather alerts, crop insurance, and soil health management services

HOW TO APPLY AND

ACCESS SCHEME

Eligible entities can apply directly through the designated implementing agency or the respective cluster support structure.

The application must follow the standard, applicable FPO or cooperative programme process as detailed by the ministry guidelines.

Interested groups should engage with their local cluster service providers to initiate verification and subsequent onboarding.

DOCUMENTS REQUIRED:

Aadhaar Cards of all promoter farmers and Directors

PAN Cards of all promoter farmers, Directors, and the FPO entity

Passport Size Photographs of all proposed Directors

Land Holding Records (RoR / 7/12 extract / Khatauni) or Farmer Identity proofs of members

Proof of Registered Office Address (Electricity bill, water bill, or land tax receipt)

No Objection Certificate (NOC) from the property owner of the registered office

Bank Account Statement or cancelled cheque of the promoters/entity

Digital Signature Certificates (DSC) for the proposed Directors

Director Identification Numbers (DIN) for the proposed Directors

Memorandum of Association (MoA) and Articles of Association (AoA) (for Producer Companies)

- **Society Bye-laws**
and **Resolution Copy** (for Cooperative Societies)

- **Share Capital Contribution Details** and member ledger summary
- **Detailed Business / Project Plan** (3 to 5-year projection)
- Documents may vary according to state and ministry.

OFFICIAL LINKS

Official Scheme Management Portal: [10K FPO MIS Portal](#). [1]

Ministry of Cooperation & Cooperative FPOs: If you are operating under a cooperative framework, converting Primary Agricultural Credit Societies (PACS) into FPOs, or setting up fisheries collectives, access the official resources via the [NCDC FPO Hub](#) and the specialized [NCDC FFPO Portal](#). [1, 2]

Central Lead Agency Portal: The Small Farmers' Agribusiness Consortium (SFAC), which acts as a principal implementing manager for the scheme, hosts dedicated documents, directory records, and scheme guidelines on the official [SFAC India FPO Portal](#). [1]
